kids. This seemed like the answer to their financial woes. They financed the costs for the publicity and the rental of a sports facility with cash advances from their credit cards. Unfortunately, they planned this too late and they ended up not having enough clients to cover their cash advances.

In a financial panic, they followed a tip from a friend that a certain tech stock was going to skyrocket. They took out cash advances on the remaining amount left on their credit cards and invested it all in the stock market, hoping to make up their losses. This risky venture, which amounted to gambling, also failed when the stock plummeted. Samuel ended up having no choice but to drop out of school and take a job at a factory in his hometown. This future was a far cry from the glamorous world of professional sports that had been his dream.

Samuel had looked for the easy way out of his financial dilemma. Fast business schemes without adequate planning and high risk stock market investing are usually a formula for disaster. Both solutions are tantamount to going to Las Vegas and betting all your money on blackjack. Although you might beat the blackjack dealer several times, the odds are stacked against you.

There are usually no fast solutions to money problems. Even solutions like a bankruptcy that may seem fast and painless, usually aren't (see Chapter 14). Samuel should have considered reducing his credit card usage and avoiding further cash advances. He could have dropped off the football team for a season and concentrated on his coursework until his grades improved. Raising his grades would have probably made him eligible for his scholarship again. The old adage "You can't get something for nothing" usually applies in most instances and Samuel's case was no exception.